

Making of the Constitution

Polity | Static revision note | One-page high-yield recap

Source basis: static constitutional history only; no fresh current-affairs material used.

Why it matters

- The Constitution was shaped by the freedom movement, colonial governance, and global constitutional ideas.
- UPSC asks the process, the people, the dates, and the borrowing behind the final text.
- Think of it as nation-building through a draft, not a single-day event.

Committees & personalities

- Drafting Committee: chaired by B.R. Ambedkar; 7 members at first, later replacements were N. Madhava Rau and T.T. Krishnamachari.
- Key names to remember: N. Gopalaswami Ayyangar, Alladi Krishnaswamy Ayyar, K.M. Munshi, Mohammad Saadulla, B.L. Mitter, D.P. Khaitan.
- Advisory Committee on Fundamental Rights, Minorities and Tribal/Excluded Areas was chaired by Vallabhbhai Patel.
- Nehru's Objective Resolution became the moral backbone of the Preamble.

Assembly snapshot

- Constituent Assembly formed under the Cabinet Mission Plan, 1946.
- Members were indirectly elected by provincial legislatures; princely states joined later.
- After Partition, the working strength became 299 members.
- Objective Resolution was moved by Jawaharlal Nehru on 13 Dec 1946 and adopted on 22 Jan 1947.

Borrowed features

- UK: parliamentary system, cabinet responsibility, rule of law, bicameralism, and parliamentary privileges.
- USA: Fundamental Rights, judicial review, and the spirit of the Preamble.
- Canada/Australia/Ireland/Weimar/USSR: federal ideas, trade and commerce provisions, Directive Principles, emergency ideas, and social justice cues.
- The Constitution is an original blend, not a copy of one country.

Milestones to remember

- Drafting Committee was set up on 29 Aug 1947.
- B.R. Ambedkar chaired the Drafting Committee.
- Constitution adopted on 26 Nov 1949 and enforced on 26 Jan 1950.
- 26 Jan was chosen to honour Purna Swaraj Day, 1930.

Prelims traps + recall

- It was not a direct-elected assembly on universal adult franchise.
- It was not borrowed wholesale from Britain or the USA.
- The Drafting Committee was only one part of a much larger constitution-making process.

Active recall

1. Who moved the Objective Resolution, and when was it adopted?
2. Which committee was chaired by Ambedkar?
3. Why is 26 January 1950 a symbolic date?

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